

USB monitor gets better

A 10-inch USB touch-screen monitor mimo has been recently launched, which can connect to any USB compatible device

Microsoft processor

Microsoft has recently succeeded in becoming the official licensee of ARM processors that are used in cellphones

HDBaseT set to replace HDMI as AV standard

Google Music to give Apple iTunes some competition



A new AV standard - HDBaseT - has been jointly developed by the surreptitiously formed industry group that comprises: LG Electronics, Sony Pictures Entertainment, Samsung Electronics, and Valens Semiconductor.

Set to replace HDMI, HDBaseT uses a regular Ethernet cable, called Cat 5e/6 network cable, which with the new technology will be able to provide HD & 3D video signals apart from data on the Ethernet connection, which still has a remarkable 100Mbit bandwidth.

A major advantage of the HDBaseT sort of cable over previous industry standards is the length of wire through which it can function, more

than four times the previous best (DiiVA), at 328 feet. This advantage is made even more extraordinary by the fact that HDBaseT cables will support 8 multi hops, effectively multiplying it to up to 2624 feet. The biggest advantage however, will be much lowered cost of the HD-capable cables - the easy affordability of normal Ethernet cables.

In case you are wondering, this will also be ideal for Google TV type internet connected services. You might also have wondered what solutions mobile devices will get, after considering the fact that many new smartphones/tablets support mini-HDMI output. The odds are, some new sort of mini-USB interfaces will be developed to work with it. 

In a world where being entertained wherever you are, on the move or at your neighbourhood coffee shop, is not considered an unreasonable demand, a paradox exists. Video and audio content certainly isn't getting any lighter, and high-definition is making a big dent in storage capacities across the world. Fortunately for us all, while content size is increasing, so is the speed and reach of mobile connectivity. Considering all this, the answer to your portable storage problems is exceedingly obvious - cloud storage.

Reports are in that iTunes is on its way to becoming a cloud service, aiming to excel at wireless streaming and syncing of content between Apple's servers, your computer and devices. iTunes is the acknowledged (U.S.) market leader for audio content, and millions of users will be glad when it shifts to the cloud, giving them the new ability to enjoy their content across a range of their devices, content that will not be limited (or at least as severely) to their device's storage capacity, and accessible from anywhere.

However, Google is certainly not going to let the cloud entertainment space go that easily, and spoke about the launch of a new music service (rumoured to be called Google Music) this American Fall at Google I/O 2010, which will offer over the air downloads for the Android platform, and remote access of the media.

Apple wouldn't be too worried about retaining its massive iTunes userbase, simply because so many users have DRM content that's tied to the platform, which they will not be willing to leave behind. Google still has an advantage though, with some of the best cloud experience in the industry, and a wide variety of cross-browser, Chrome-based, and Android applications.

The same reports that partially detail Apple's cloud initiatives, say that the services (iTunes, Apple TV, and more) will be launched around the American Fall, which is the same time that Google Music and Google TV are expected. This is also around the same time that another phase of competition between Apple and Google will begin - mobile advertising - when iAds will battle AdSense for supremacy. 



Google takes over ITA

Billion dollar companies have a penchant for acquiring technology the easy way, and Google's takeover of ITA Software, a leading flight information company, for \$700 million, is a classic example.

The industry is certainly buzzing with questions. What

exactly does Google intend to do with a \$700 million flight information company? Google has not said how they intend to use ITA, except by commenting that they'd honour all of ITA's previous commitments; most notably service agreements with Microsoft's Bing, apart from the more obvious Kayak and Orbitz. 

